



Yacht Management & Marine Services

Freedom To enjoy



RELAUNCH CHECKLIST 1 OF 2

Pre-Launch

The day she goes back in the water: what to see on the hardstand, in the engine room and in the slings before the lift lets go.

Vessel: _____ Relaunch date: _____ Shipyard: _____

Yard contact: _____

1 PAPERWORK, BEFORE THE LIFT IS BOOKED

- ☐ **Invoice reconciled to the quote**
Every extra is a priced line you approved.
- ☐ **Photos of the underwater work received**
Hull, anodes, props, shafts, seacocks: your record for next year.
- ☐ **Paint brand, grade and litres recorded**
Next year's quote starts from this.
- ☐ **Anode sizes and part numbers recorded**
- ☐ **Relaunch day, time and tide confirmed**
Ask who from the yard stays with her in the slings.
- ☐ **Insurance in force for the relaunch**
Who carries her between the slings and your berth.

2 HULL, BELOW THE WATERLINE

- ☐ **Antifoul complete, no misses, waterline right**
Keel-block and sling marks painted after the lift.
- ☐ **Anodes fitted, bonded, not painted over**
Hull, shaft, rudder, trim tabs, thrusters.
- ☐ **Propellers torqued: nut, key, split pin**
Propspeed cured for as long as the can says.
- ☐ **Shafts, cutless bearings, P-brackets, cutters**
No play in the bearing; cutters clear of the prop.
- ☐ **Rudders: no play, stock seals and bearings**
- ☐ **Every through-hull fitted, hoses double-clipped**
Count them against last year's list.
- ☐ **Transducers and paddle-wheel refitted**
The classic relaunch leak is an empty housing.
- ☐ **Trim tabs, interceptors, thruster props and anodes**
- ☐ **Stabiliser fins secure, seals checked**
- ☐ **Swim platform, ladder and underwater lights**

FOUND BEFORE THE SPLASH anything not right on the hardstand, and who is fixing it

Checked by: _____ Date: _____

Pre-Launch — continued

3 ENGINE ROOM, BEFORE SHE TOUCHES THE WATER

- ☐ Engine oil, gearbox oil and coolant at the marks
- ☐ Raw-water strainers clean, lids on, seals seated
A strainer lid left loose floods the bilge at the first start.
- ☐ Impellers fitted, raw-water hoses connected
The yard changes them dry. Check the hose clips went back on.
- ☐ Shaft seals ready: dripless seals burped, water lines connected
A dry dripless seal burns in minutes.
- ☐ Belts, hoses and fuel filters checked
- ☐ Bilges clean, dry and clear of rags, tools and fasteners
Anything left in the bilge finds a pump.
- ☐ Bilge pumps and float switches tested by hand
High-water alarm too.
- ☐ Batteries charged, isolators and bonding reconnected
- ☐ Fire suppression re-armed; extinguishers in their brackets
The yard disarms it for hot work.
- ☐ Shore power lead ready for the berth; inverter and charger set

4 DECK AND ABOVE

- ☐ Covers off; mast, aerials, anchor and chain refitted
Anything the yard took off for the shed comes back on before the lift.
- ☐ Lines and fenders rigged for the berth you are going to
- ☐ Hatches, ports and windows closed; gas off at the bottle
- ☐ Navigation lights, horn, wipers and VHF tested on shore power
- ☐ Electronics on: plotter, depth, radar, engine displays
Confirm the depth sounder reads once she is in.
- ☐ Fuel for the sea trial and the run home; fresh water on board
- ☐ Tender, davit and toys secured
- ☐ Nothing loose on deck that was stowed for the yard
Deck chairs, hoses, ladders, the yard's own gear.

ENGINE ROOM AND DECK levels, what the yard changed, anything still off the boat

ITEM READING OR STATE ACTION

Checked by: _____ Date: _____

Pre-Launch — continued

5 IN THE SLINGS: THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES

- ☐ **Stay in the slings. Do not let the yard release her yet**
The lift holds her while you look. This is the only time it costs nothing.
- ☐ **Inside: every through-hull, shaft seal and transducer, with a torch**
Dry hand on each one. Water on your hand is a leak.
- ☐ **Seacocks exercised open and shut, then set**
- ☐ **Engines started: cooling water at every exhaust within seconds**
No water at an exhaust: stop that engine. Impeller or strainer.
- ☐ **No alarms; oil pressure up; no smoke, no leaks under the engines**
- ☐ **Generator started and under load; air-conditioning raw water flowing**
- ☐ **Thrusters bow and stern, both directions**
- ☐ **Steering lock to lock; rudder indicator true to the helm**
- ☐ **Bilges checked again before release**
Then release.

6 LEAVING THE YARD

- ☐ **Short run first, at idle, with the engine-room door open**
Listen. Look at the shaft seals and strainers under way.
- ☐ **Sea trial booked, or run now if the weather allows**
The sea trial checklist is the next two pages.
- ☐ **Engine and generator hours logged at relaunch**
- ☐ **Yard contact for the first 24 hours written down**
- ☐ **Bilges checked at one hour, at the berth, and again the next day**
A slow weep from a seacock or transducer shows up overnight.
- ☐ **Hardstand days, lift cost and paint litres written into next year's plan**

Stay in the slings until you have looked. Nearly every relaunch leak is a transducer, a strainer lid or a seacock hose, and all of them show in the first fifteen minutes while the lift still holds her. Once she is released, the same leak is a tow.

RELAUNCH RECORD one line for the day: the leak check, the first start, the release

TIME IN SLINGS LEAKS FOUND ENGINES STARTED RELEASED AT

Yard: Skipper: Engine hours:

Sea Trial

After a relaunch, after major work, or before you buy: the checks and readings that prove she is right, on the form our crews use.

Vessel: _____ Date: _____ Captain: _____ Crew: _____

Purpose: _____ Location: _____ Swell / wind / visibility: _____

1 MACHINERY HOURS AND FUEL hour-meter readings at start-up and at the finish

EQUIPMENT

HOURS AT START-UP

HOURS AT FINISH

Main engine, port

Main engine, starboard

Generator, port

Generator, starboard

Watermaker

Stabilisers or gyro

Other equipment tested

Fuel on board, litres: before and after

2 PRE-DEPARTURE CHECKS

- ☐ Fuel sufficient for the trial
- ☐ Engine oil and coolant levels checked
- ☐ Seacocks and raw-water intakes open
- ☐ Bilges checked and dry
- ☐ Batteries charged, isolators on
- ☐ Shore power disconnected and stowed
- ☐ Lines and fenders ready
- ☐ Navigation lights and electronics on
- ☐ VHF radio check
- ☐ Safety gear aboard: lifejackets, EPIRB, extinguishers
- ☐ Weather and tide checked
- ☐ Crew briefed on roles
- ☐ Engine-room visual inspection
- ☐ Steering and controls free through the full range

3 START-UP CHECKS, ENGINES RUNNING

- ☐ Cooling water flow at all exhausts
- ☐ No fire, smoke, fuel or oil leaks
- ☐ RPM steady at idle
- ☐ No engine or system alarms
- ☐ Steering: full lock port and starboard
- ☐ Rudder indicator reads true to the helm
- ☐ Autopilot engages and holds course

BEFORE LEAVING THE BERTH anything found at start-up, and whether the trial went ahead

Captain: _____ Time of departure: _____

Sea Trial — continued

4 SYSTEMS CHECKED: PROPULSION AND MACHINERY

- ☐ Main engines
- ☐ Gearboxes and transmission
- ☐ Generators
- ☐ Gyro or fin stabilisers
- ☐ Bow and stern thrusters
- ☐ Trim tabs
- ☐ Steering and autopilot
- ☐ Shaft seals: drip rate
- ☐ Fuel system: no leaks
- ☐ Cooling and exhaust: temperatures and smoke
- ☐ Batteries and charging
- ☐ Engine interface and displays
- ☐ Bilge pumps and alarms

5 SYSTEMS CHECKED: NAVIGATION, DECK AND DOMESTIC

- ☐ Chart plotter and navigation
- ☐ Radar
- ☐ Depth sounder
- ☐ VHF radios
- ☐ Navigation lights
- ☐ Horn
- ☐ Windscreen wipers and washers
- ☐ Anchor and windlass
- ☐ Air conditioning
- ☐ Watermaker
- ☐ Toilets, fresh and grey water
- ☐ Fire and safety equipment

6 RUN PROCEDURE

- ☐ Readings at 500 RPM steps, five minutes at each
- ☐ Run 30 minutes at 80 percent load
- ☐ Wide open throttle for ten minutes: temperatures, smoke, vibration
- ☐ Shaft-seal drip rate checked at cruise
- ☐ Engine-room inspection after the run
- ☐ Seacock leak and ease check after the run

UNDER WAY anything heard, felt or smelt; where in the rev range; what the engine room looked like after the run

TIME SPEED / RPM OBSERVATION

Captain: Transducer offset:

Sea Trial — continued

7 PERFORMANCE READINGS target speed down the side; write what she actually did

TARGET	SPEED (KTS)	FUEL BURN (L/HR)	ENGINE LOAD	RPM	TEMP (°C)
Idle					
5 kt					
10 kt					
12 kt					
15 kt					
20 kt					
25 kt					
30 kt					
WOT / max					

What the numbers tell you. Fuel burn divided by speed is litres per nautical mile; the economical cruise is where that is lowest above displacement speed. Temperatures should climb and settle. A temperature still climbing at wide open throttle after ten minutes is a cooling problem, not a hot day. Black smoke under load is overload or fuel; blue is oil; white is water or a cold engine. Vibration that comes in at one speed and goes again is usually a propeller.

OUTCOME AND ITEMS TO ACTION pass, or what has to be fixed, by whom and by when

ITEM ACTION WHO BY WHEN

Captain: _____ Date: _____ Outcome: _____

MHQ-LS-001 · \$12 · Part of The Yacht Owner's Kit. © Marine HQ Pty Ltd. Sold as an information document for your own vessel; it is not a survey, a compliance certificate or a substitute for the manufacturer's manuals or a qualified marine professional. Not for resale.

Freedom To enjoy

m: 0439 748 387

e: yachtsupport@marinehq.com.au

w: www.marinehq.com.au

